Referring to Images Unambiguously

Previously, when we named our image on page 31, we simply called it railsapp. Similarly, Compose automatically named our web service image myapp_web. Although these names worked fine when working on a single Docker Machine, they aren't suitable for sharing our image on a Docker Registry.

Why? Because what if different people, teams, or organizations all want to have an image called railsapp or myapp_web? How would we know which image to refer to? This is a solved problem: by referring to both the image name *and* a user account, we disambiguate which image we're referring to and allow people to call their images whatever they like without fear of name clashes.

We refer, unambiguously, to a particular image (more precisely, a specific *version* of an image) by using the following naming convention:

```
[<registry hostname>[:port]/]<username>/<image name>[:<tag>]
```

The Registry hostname is optional; leaving it out indicates you're referring to the default Registry: Docker Hub. If a Registry hostname is provided without an explicit port, the standard SSL port 443 is assumed.[4]

As we'll see in a moment, an account is needed to store images on a Registry, and an account can house any number of distinctly named images. The <username>/<image name> combination refers to the particular image in a given user account. In fact, everything up until the optional tag is known as the *repository name*:

```
[<registry hostname>[:port]/]<username>/<image name>
```

A repository can store multiple tagged versions of the image; we refer to a particular version of the image either by specifying an explicit tag or, as we saw previously, on page 31 by letting the default tag—latest—be used.

For example, since my Docker Hub username is robisenberg, to share the latest version of an image called myapp_web on Docker Hub, I'd use the repository name robisenberg/myapp_web.

Repository Names in Examples



In the commands that follow, you will need to replace my account name (robisenberg) with whatever you called yours.

4. https://docs.docker.com/registry/deploying/#run-an-externally-accessible-registry